UCW MBA Program Learning Outcomes and Rubrics

PLO1

Program Learning Outcome: Construct strategic responses to business challenges/opportunities.

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
1.1 Analyze Strategic Context	Uses multiple relevant frameworks, diverse evidence, technology-supported insights where appropriate, and considers economic, social, environmental, AND Indigenous contexts to develop a comprehensive description of the strategic situation.	Uses relevant frameworks, credible evidence, and some appropriate contextual factors to analyze the business situation and identify key challenges or opportunities.	Uses limited or inappropriate frameworks and evidence, with minimal consideration of relevant contextual factors, resulting in an incomplete or unsupported analysis.
1.2 Evaluate Strategic Alternatives	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and evaluates three or more alternatives; explicitly weighs risks against opportunities for each alternative; supports the evaluation with specific evidence (financial data, market research, case facts) rather than general assertion; identifies impacts across multiple stakeholder groups (e.g., customers,	Compares at least two strategic alternatives against explicitly stated criteria (e.g., cost, feasibility, risk, time to implement); identifies impacts on at least one key stakeholder group for each alternative	Considers only one alternative, or presents multiple alternatives without stating the criteria used to compare them; stakeholder impacts are not identified, or are asserted without supporting reasoning

Commented [LT1]: This is the main distinguishing factor between the "meets" and "exceeds." Would all of these (economic, social, environmental, and Indigenous) always be required?

Commented [AS2R1]: Yes, for the strategic context analysis it is good to apply all four dimensions.

	employees, shareholders, community)		
1.3 Construct Strategic Responses	Develops a feasible, innovative, and evidence-based strategic response that aligns with organizational goals, stakeholder needs, and implementation requirements.	Develops a practical strategic response supported by analysis, relevant evidence, and consideration of implementation requirements.	Proposes a response that is unrealistic, insufficiently supported, or disconnected from the analysis of the business challenge or opportunity.

Commented [LT3]: They have to provide multiple to "exceed"? Or one innovative, etc strategic response is enough?

PLO2

Program Learning Outcome: Assess ethical implications of business activities.

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
2.1. Identify Ethical Issues	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and explicitly explains how two or more identified issues are connected (e.g., resolving one affects another); identifies at least one specific instance where stakeholder interests conflict, rather than listing interests separately; addresses Indigenous rights or interests when the situation involves them; traces at least one broader societal implication beyond the immediate organization (e.g., regulatory precedent, industry-wide effect, long-term reputational risk)	Identifies at least two distinct ethical issues; names the stakeholder group(s) affected by each issue; states at least one broader social or organizational implication (e.g., reputational, regulatory, financial) for at least one issue	Fails to identify significant ethical issues, stakeholder concerns, or broader implications related to the situation.
2.2. Analyze Ethical Context	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and applies two or more ethical frameworks and compares what each implies for the situation; explicitly connects at least two contextual factors to one another (e.g., explains how a legal requirement conflicts with or is shaped	Names and correctly applies at least one recognized ethical framework (e.g., utilitarianism, deontology, virtue ethics, stakeholder	Does not name a specific ethical framework, or applies one in a way that contradicts its own stated principles; addresses zero or one of the four

Commented [LT4]: 2.2 is not distinct enough from 2.1

Commented [AS5R4]: They are not exactly the same as 2.2. adds more scope while 2.1. only focuses on issues.

	by a cultural norm) rather than listing them separately; states an ethical conclusion and ties it back to specific framework principles as justification	theory) to the situation; addresses at least three of the four contextual factors (legal, cultural, technological, social), each discussed individually	contextual factors (legal, cultural, technological, social)
2.3. Make Responsible Recommendations	Recommends ethical, accountable, and sustainable actions supported by sound reasoning, stakeholder considerations, and awareness of short- and long-term consequences.	Recommends ethically appropriate actions supported by reasoning, consideration of stakeholders, and awareness of potential consequences.	Recommends actions that lack ethical justification, accountability, or consideration of stakeholder impacts and long-term consequences.

PLO3

Program Learning Outcome: Develop, implement, and evaluate solutions to business problems.

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
3.1 Diagnose & Define Problems	Identifies root causes using evidence from multiple perspectives, integrates relevant data and stakeholder insights, and demonstrates a comprehensive understanding of underlying factors influencing the problem.	Identifies key issues using relevant information and demonstrates an understanding of the main factors contributing to the problem.	Provides a limited or inaccurate understanding of the problem, with unclear root causes and insufficient supporting evidence.
3.2 Design & Implement Solutions	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and identifies at least one specific implementation risk paired with a concrete mitigation or contingency step (not just "monitor closely"); sequences actions with explicit dependencies (what must happen before what, and by when); where a technology-enabled tool or process would materially aid execution, names the specific tool/process and how it's used — rather than a generic reference to "leveraging technology"	Specifies concrete actions in sequence; identifies specific resources required (budget, staffing, time) with enough detail to act on; identifies at least one stakeholder group affected by implementation and how they are affected	Plan omits required actions, resources, or affected stakeholders, or specifies them too vagely to act on (e.g., "allocate sufficient budget" without a figure or source); includes actions inconsistent with stated constraints (e.g., timeline, budget, staffing)
3.3 Evaluate & Improve	Uses meaningful measures to evaluate outcomes, analyzes	Evaluates outcomes using appropriate criteria and identifies	Provides limited or unsupported evaluation of

Solutions	performance results, identifies areas for improvement, and proposes continuous improvement strategies to enhance solution effectiveness over time.	opportunities to improve solution effectiveness.	outcomes, with little evidence of reflection or consideration of improvement opportunities.

PLO4

Program Learning Outcome: Formulate business decisions and systematic analysis that reflects critical thinking.

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
4.1. Identify Relevant Information Amidst Uncertainty	Demonstrates critical and comprehensive evaluation of evidence, assumptions, uncertainties, technologically-aided search outputs, and information gaps.	Recognizes relevant information, evidence and uncertainties, with some critical and comprehensive evaluation.	Displays a limited, inaccurate, or unsupported evaluation of or overlooks important information and evidence.
4.2 Explore Perspectives & Assumptions	Integrates multiple viewpoints in exploration, including Indigenous and diverse perspectives, while recognizing bias.	Considers a few alternative viewpoints in exploration of perspectives and assumptions.	Fails to consider alternative viewpoints in exploration and/or relies on a single perspective.
4.3 Evaluate Merits & Limitations	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and weighs the merits against the limitations for at least one alternative to reach an explicit judgment about its net desirability (not merely listing both sides); describes at least one potential outcome in terms of likelihood or magnitude (e.g., "likely," "a significant cost increase," a range) rather than as a flat yes/no result; compares limitations across	Identifies at least one merit and one limitation for each alternative considered; connects each merit or limitation to a specific likely outcome of that alternative (e.g., "faster to implement" tied to "reduces exposure to a competitor's first-mover advantage")	Fails to identify or ignores the merits and limitations of alternatives.

Commented [LT6]: Has overlap with PLOs 3 and 9

Commented [AS7R6]: Good point. I think we should bring it to the CoP discussion.

Commented [LT8R6]: Okay. I recommend removing this dimension. Open to CoP discussion.

Commented [LT9]: Seems very similar to 3.1

Commented [AS10R9]: 4.1 precedes 3.1 (recognize information and then identify key issues). Subject to discussion during CoP.

	alternatives to identify which are more manageable or more severe relative to each other		
4.34 Finalize & Justify Decisions	Uses explicit and comprehensive decision criteria when formulating decisions and provides evidence-based justification to support the decision rationale.	Provides evidence-based justification to support the decision rationale without explicitly stated criteria.	Provides weak or unsupported justification for decisions, if any.

* Orders of 4.3 and 4.4 changed, we recommend changing the numbering too.

Commented [LT11]: This doesn't matter. Whatever the team likes.

PLO5

Program Learning Outcome: Collaborate effectively as a business leader and team member in cross-cultural and global contexts to achieve common goals.

Commented [LT12]: This PLO needs significant work to move it away from interpersonal and cultural subjectivity. It currently runs the risk of poorly rating students for having a different communication style or contribution style than the instructor. We're very likely to see demographic-related biases from this.

To resolve: Try getting very specific in each cell of the table. For example, "Asks for input for other team members at least once per group meeting."

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
5.1 Contribute to Group Work	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, **and** demonstrably improves team output beyond own assigned task — e.g., identifies and resolves a gap/error in another member's work, proposes a solution later adopted by the team, or takes on additional coordination/integration work reflected in team artifacts	Completes assigned tasks on time and to a workable standard; responds to teammate feedback with revisions; peer/self-assessment and team artifacts (meeting notes, task log,	Misses agreed deadlines or deliverables more than once; contributions require rework by teammates without offering revisions; peer/self-assessment or team log shows contribution below an equitable share of team tasks

Commented [LT13]: What are we planning on applying this rubric to? Recorded team meetings?

Commented [OA14R13]: Yes, this could be an option. But better still, team peer evaluations would constitute another source of information.

		shared documents) show a fair share of team workload	
5.2 Display Inclusive Collaboration	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and initiates a specific, documented action that measurably increased a teammate's participation. For example, followed up individually with a teammate outside of group meetings to incorporate input that hadn't surfaced in discussion (reflected in messages or revised drafts), restructured task allocation to fit a stated need, or explicitly handed a leadership moment (running a meeting segment, presenting the team's work) to a quieter member, etc.	Team artifacts (meeting notes, peer evaluation, shared documents) show at least one documented instance of soliciting input from a teammate before a decision was finalized, and credits teammates' ideas by name in discussion or written work	Peer evaluation, self-assessment, or team log documents a specific instance of dismissing, interrupting, or excluding a teammate's contribution; or no evidence in team artifacts of soliciting input from teammates beyond default meeting attendance

Commented [LT15]: Again, these descriptors are very subjective and don't offer enough objective criteria to ground instructors' judgment.

Commented [OA16R15]: Seems like another item to be discussed in the larger CoP group.

PLO6

Program Learning Outcome: Lead teams through the resolution of problems and successful completion of projects and tasks.

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
6.1 Perform Emerging Leadership Behaviors	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and demonstrates leadership actions across at least two distinct categories (structuring work, resolving conflict, re-engaging a disengaged teammate), with evidence that a specific action directly prevented a negative outcome (e.g., a missed deadline, a stalled deliverable) — documented in team log, peer evaluation, or instructor observation	At least one documented instance of: proposing a plan or structure the team otherwise lacked (e.g., task breakdown, meeting agenda, decision process), **or** resolving a specific team conflict or stalled decision — reflected in team log or peer evaluation	No documented instance of the student initiating structure, resolving a stalled decision or conflict, or re-engaging a disengaged teammate, when the team log or peer evaluation shows such a need arose
6.2 Integrate Organizational Considerations into Team Decisions	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and incorporates three or more considerations; explicitly identifies at least one instance where two considerations trade off against each other (e.g., an innovation opportunity that raises sustainability concerns) and explains how the team's recommendation resolves or navigates that tradeoff	Deliverable explicitly incorporates at least two of the four considerations into the team's recommendation or decision, with stated reasoning connecting each consideration to the outcome (not merely listed)	Team deliverable addresses zero or one of the four considerations (ethics, sustainability, innovation, technology) explicitly, or a consideration is mentioned without being connected to the team's actual recommendation or decision

Commented [LT17]: This isn't a dimension but a brief restatement of the whole PLO.

PLO7

Program Learning Outcome: Integrate personal values and perspectives into problem solving and take responsibility for decisions.

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
7.1 Identify Personal Values and Perspectives	Critically reflects on personal values, assumptions, and perspectives, integrating them with alternative viewpoints to guide business decisions.	Identifies personal values and incorporates them into decision-making with clear evidence of alignment.	Demonstrates weak or unclear personal values with no discernable connection to decision-making processes.
7.2 Maintain Accountability	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and explicitly evaluates whether the outcome aligned with the originally stated objective (not just whether it "worked out"); when the outcome fell short of that objective, identifies the specific gap between intended and actual result and explains why it occurred; connects the reflection to a general principle or approach for future decisions, rather than only a fix specific to this one case	Explicitly attributes the outcome to their own decision or action; states the specific reasoning or criteria used in making that decision; identifies at least one specific thing they would repeat or change if facing a similar situation again	Attributes the outcome primarily to external factors, other people, or circumstances rather than to their own decision; does not state the reasoning behind the decision at the time it was made; does not identify anything they would repeat or change if facing the situation again

Commented [LT18]: Will all students have the opportunity to do this? Can I have an example of student work this could be applied to?

Commented [MG19R18]: For example, when a student evaluates their contribution, acknowledges limitations in their decisions, and identifies improvements for future collaboration, the reflection on how their assumptions influenced the outcomes/recommendations, or a student proposes a business strategy, justifies why certain alternatives were rejected, and discusses potential unintended consequences.

Commented [LT20R18]: I disagree that proposing business strategies really aligns with maintaining personal accountability.

What you've described as a reflection process could apply (i.e., evaluating one's own contribution, acknowledging limitations, identifying improvements for the future). However, I'm not under the impression that most of our courses have something like this, meaning we would have to institute a new student assignment to align with this dimension.

Commented [AS21R18]: Our suggestion is to discuss it during CoP.

PLO8

Program Learning Outcome: Communicate ideas persuasively (written and oral) as a result of thorough analysis of information.

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
8.1 Written Communication	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and anticipates and explicitly addresses at least one counterargument or alternative interpretation of the evidence; uses specific, concrete evidence to support every major claim; demonstrates strong command of grammar, spelling, punctuation, and formatting with minimal to no errors, and clear, precise sentence-level construction throughout	States a clear central argument or recommendation early in the document; supports each major claim with specific evidence from the analysis; organizes content in a logical sequence appropriate to the document type; grammar, spelling, punctuation, and formatting follow professional business writing conventions, with occasional minor errors	Central argument or recommendation is unclear, absent, or not stated until late in the document; claims are asserted without supporting evidence from the analysis; grammar, spelling, punctuation, or formatting contains frequent errors inconsistent with professional business writing standards
8.2 Oral Communication	Delivers engaging presentations that effectively integrate presentation techniques (e.g., eye contact, storytelling, multimedia elements, varied speaking rate and pitch, and well-designed slides) with visuals to reinforce key business ideas.	Delivers clear, professional presentations that effectively communicate business ideas.	Presentation lacks clarity, organization, or effective delivery.
8.3 Maintain Focus on the Relevant Audience	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and adapts communication across multiple aspects simultaneously	Explicitly identifies the intended audience; adapts at least one aspect of communication (e.g.,	Fails to adapt communication to the relevant audience.

	(e.g., tone, structure, technical detail, and content selection together); when more than one audience is relevant, addresses each audience's distinct needs separately (e.g., a different framing for executives than for technical staff) rather than using one generic version for everyone	tone, level of technical detail, or content included/excluded) to match that audience's background or needs	

PLO9

Program Learning Outcome: Gather, analyze, and synthesize information for a business context

Dimension	Exceeds Standard	Meets Standard	Does Not Meet Standard
9.1 Gather & Validate Information	Critically evaluates diverse, credible sources, leveraging sophisticated analytical tools, community wisdom (as appropriate), and research assets from varied perspectives.	Utilizes relevant and credible sources to support business analysis.	Relies on weak, irrelevant, or insufficient sources for decision-making.
9.2 Analyze & Synthesize Information	Meets all "Meets Standard" criteria, and draws on three or more sources or perspectives (e.g., different data types, stakeholder viewpoints, or conflicting reports) to identify at least two distinct patterns or relationships; explicitly addresses a contradiction or tension between sources rather than presenting them as if they agree	Draws on information from at least two distinct sources or datasets to identify at least one explicit pattern or relationship (e.g., a trend, a correlation, a cause-and-effect link) that is not stated directly in any single source	Presents information source-by-source without connecting it (e.g., summarizes each source in isolation), or states a conclusion not traceable to the information presented; identifies no explicit pattern or relationship across sources
9.3 Generate Insights	Develops actionable, evidence-based insights while explicitly acknowledging limitations to prevent oversight.	Develops reasonable insights that are adequately supported by evidence.	Insights are absent, weak, unsupported, or contrary to critical evidence.

Commented [LT22]: Consider whether this dimension is really included in the PLO.

Commented [MG23R22]: I think generating insights is a natural outcome of synthesis, especially in a business context. In business education, the purpose of analyzing and synthesizing information is not simply to summarize findings; it is to derive meaningful interpretations that inform understanding and action.

Commented [LT24R22]: I understand what you're saying. I disagree that this is currently inherent to the PLO. We can maintain it in the rubric if the CoP agrees; however, we should consider modifying this PLO in the future.

Commented [AS25R22]: Our suggestion is to discuss this during CoP.